



Named a Date, Won the Enquiry

Replicating a Laundromat Patience Finding on Rental “For Lease” Signs

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Background

A laundromat study found a specific repair date buys more patience than vague reassurance, whether or not the date holds. Whether the same holds for a rental sign’s advertised move-in date, where the stakes are a lease rather than a wash, is untested.

Aims

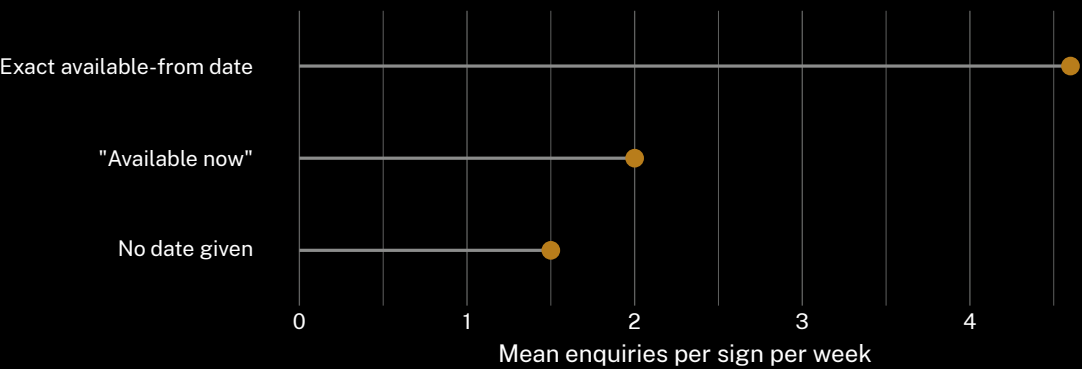
- Replicate the laundromat “specific date beats vague reassurance” finding on a new signal: rental “for lease” signs
- Compare enquiry volume for an exact available-from date against “available now” and no date at all
- Test whether the advertised date bears on when the property is actually ready

Methods

- 187 “for lease” signs · 6 suburbs · 14-week window
- signs coded: exact date, “available now”, or no date given
- enquiry counts from the agency’s own call log; readiness checked against the lease start

Results

Signs naming an exact available-from date drew 2.3 times the enquiries of an “available now” sign and 3.1 times a sign with no date at all — yet the named date predicted the property’s actual move-in readiness no better than chance.



Signs naming an exact date average 4.6 enquiries a week, against 2.0 for “available now” and 1.5 for no date — though the named date matches actual move-in readiness only 31% of the time, indistinguishable from chance.

Discussion & conclusions

A named date reads as a commitment even when it isn’t one; the enquiry follows the specificity, not the property’s actual state. The laundromat finding travels: interest tracks the shape of a promise, not its keeping. Next: whether a publicly wrong date erodes trust in the next sign the same agency posts.

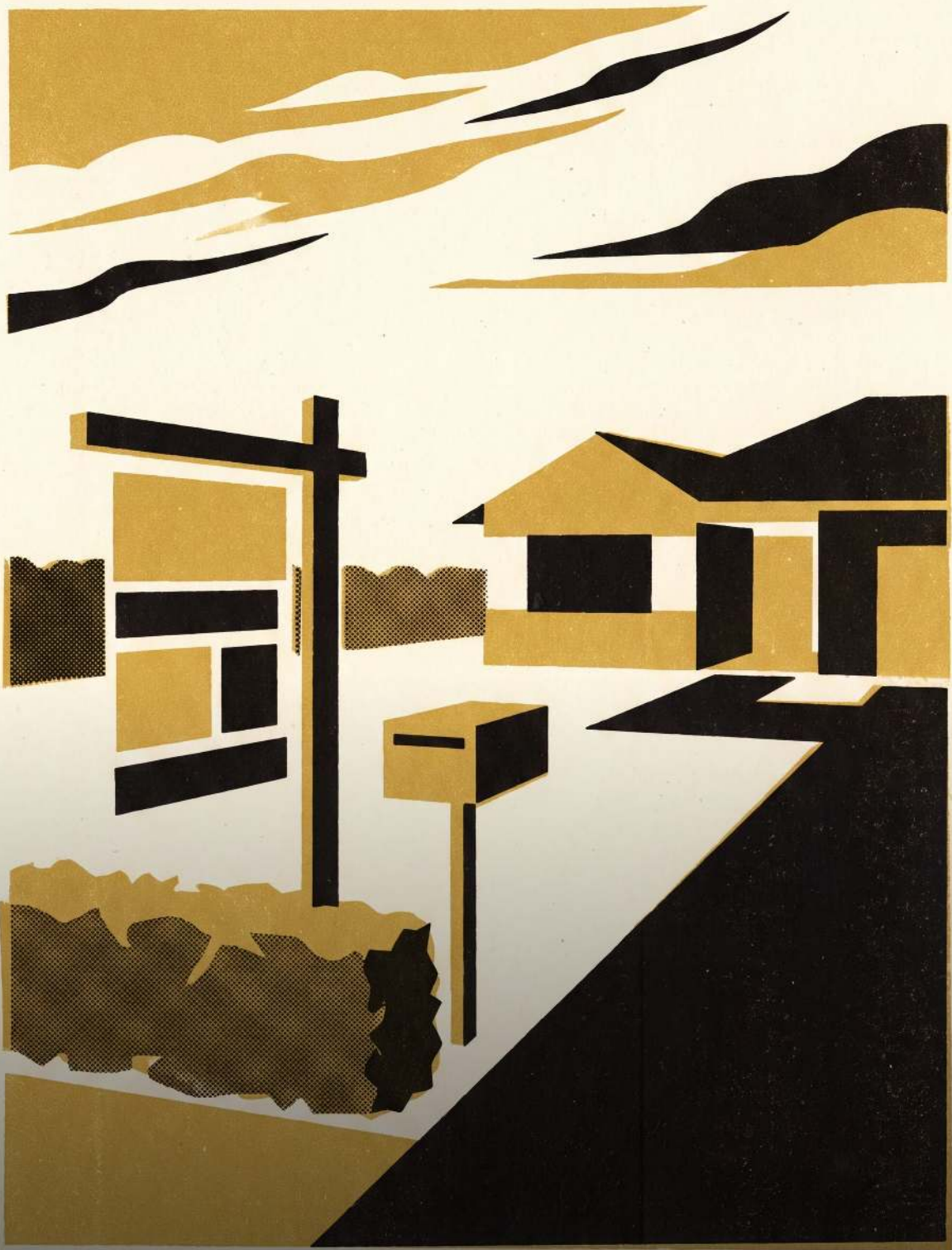
References

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We thank the six participating real estate agencies. Enquiry counts drawn from agency call logs; readiness checked against lodged lease start dates only.

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“A date won the enquiry, kept or not.”

A named date drew 2.3× the enquiries of “available now.”